

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Family Paralegal role advertised through Gemini Recruitment because my existing experience in client-facing legal advisory work, case file management and procedural drafting maps directly onto what a busy family law team needs from a paralegal.

My most relevant experience comes from Citizens Advice East Berkshire, where I advise clients daily across housing, family, welfare benefits, employment and debt matters. Many of these clients are in difficult personal circumstances, so the work requires careful factual-taking, clear communication and sound judgement about what issues to prioritise. I draft correspondence, prepare document schedules, maintain confidential case records and manage matters from initial instruction through to submission, all against firm deadlines. That combination of client-facing responsibility and case administration is directly transferable to supporting a family law team.

Before that, I spent a year on placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, where I worked across international arbitration and real estate disputes. In the arbitration team I became the only junior supporting a complex investment arbitration shortly before a major filing deadline, coordinating documents, tracking outstanding actions and helping ensure the submission was made on time. In the real estate disputes team I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and managed large volumes of documents across several matters with competing deadlines. Both rotations developed my ability to handle volume and complexity without letting detail slip, which I understand is essential in a busy family team dealing with court deadlines and sensitive personal matters.

The firm's breadth across more than 25 practice areas across London and England and Wales appeals to me because it suggests a structured environment where a paralegal can develop real depth in family law while understanding how it sits alongside other disciplines. My background spans contentious and advisory work rather than a single practice area, and I want to build on that by focusing on family law specifically, which I have encountered most directly through the family matters I handle at Citizens Advice.

I am available at short notice for interview and would welcome the chance to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva